



Get paid to find bugs

Oculus Rift wants security researchers to find bugs and problems in exchange of rewards <http://dgit.in/PaidForBugs>



Estimote stickers FTW

Packing accelerometers and temperature sensors, these stickers will totally broaden the capabilities of the Internet of Things <http://dgit.in/Estimote>

detailed hand movements or facial expressions, making it a Kinect-like device.

The team of researchers were successful in making actual working depth sensors from a modified Android smartphone as well as a regular Microsoft webcam. Both the devices were successfully able to track a user's hands and face. This technology would allow users to modify gadgets to respond to gestures.

The cameras pick up infrared light which, combined with algorithms, show depth. The demo video shows high accuracy and users can even pinch hands mid-air to zoom on screen. The variation of normal light in a room don't affect the infrared.

Another team of researchers have developed their own RGB-depth camera out of off-the-shelf parts. The technology could help figure out a way to meld it with software to capture 3D models of people and objects that deform, shift and move in real-time. No information is available when or if this kit will come to market.

Microsoft researchers under Project Adam are giving Microsoft's voice assistant Cortana the ability to identify objects. The team claims that the project is

50 times faster and twice as precise as Google's 16,000 computer neural network-powered image recognition system. The technology was showed off by Microsoft Research's executive vice president of technology and research, Harry Shum at the company's Faculty Summit. The technology could help build new tools for visually challenged users.

The smart helmet

The smartphone market may be reaching a point of saturation, but there are two other segments of smart devices that seem to be coming to the mainstream — in-car tech and wearables. Now here's something that combines those two segments. The Skully AR-1 is an Android-powered motorcycle helmet, which lets you do a lot of things that regular helmets can't and it's gone up for pre-order now, at a price of \$1,399 (₹85,471 approximately), slated to begin shipping from May 2015.

The company calls this the 'World's smartest motorcycle helmet'. It runs on Android and can pair with your phone through Bluetooth, allowing you to play music, take calls, navigate and go online, using only voice commands. Informa-



Is Samsung going to lead the development of the foldable screen?

tion is projected onto the helmet's visor, along with a rear view display. It has an ultra-wide angle rear view camera attached to the back that projects what is behind you onto the rear view screen.

The price of the helmet will go up to \$1,499 (₹91,581 approximately) after it is launched, which means that you can save \$100 (₹6,000 approximately) by ordering it now. The device had been put up on Indiegogo for a crowdfunding campaign and has reached almost triple its target, with \$800,000 amassed so far. It is DOT/ECE certified and has a fog, scratch and glare resistant visor.

Foldable screens a reality?

Samsung new foldable smartphone patent shows a device that can fold completely in half. The patent shows that the device has a "kickstand" mode, which can be used as a clock while other pictures show it in various positions while being bent in different directions.

According to the patent images the Samsung device has a flexible body, which could be embedded in the style of its existing smartphones. The

bendable shape of the smartphone can be maintained due to hinges in the body. The patent was published by the US Patent Office last week, though it had already been patented earlier in February this year. However it remains to be seen when the smartphone will actually be launched.

Samsung showed its bendable tablet at the MWC in Barcelona in February. The tablet can be bent at 90 degrees and can be used as a tablet or a laptop. The lower half of the tablet can function as a keyboard and the upper half as a screen. A company spokesperson stated that Samsung plans to launch its foldable portfolio in early 2015.

Samsung is also planning to launch the much awaited Galaxy Note 4, Gear Glass and its Gear VR headset at the IFA event in Berlin this month. Rumors about a special Galaxy Note 4 with a flexible display are also making the rounds. The phone will reportedly feature a three-sided wraparound display that will completely eliminate side bezels and will offer touchscreen buttons on the phone's edges. No details have been given about the phones launch. 



The smartest helmet you could have